

Flavor Find

Find the flavor. Fill the table.

Master Plan

Recipe Engine | Consumer Apps | Hotel Platform | AI Assistant

Vision, architecture, market, pricing, go-to-market and roadmap

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1. The Big Idea

Most people decide what to eat in a messy way: they look at what is in the kitchen, what they crave, what they can afford, and what the menu happens to offer. Flavor Find turns that into a conversation with a smart engine that knows food, and specifically **knows Kenyan and East African food**, which the big global recipe platforms barely cover.

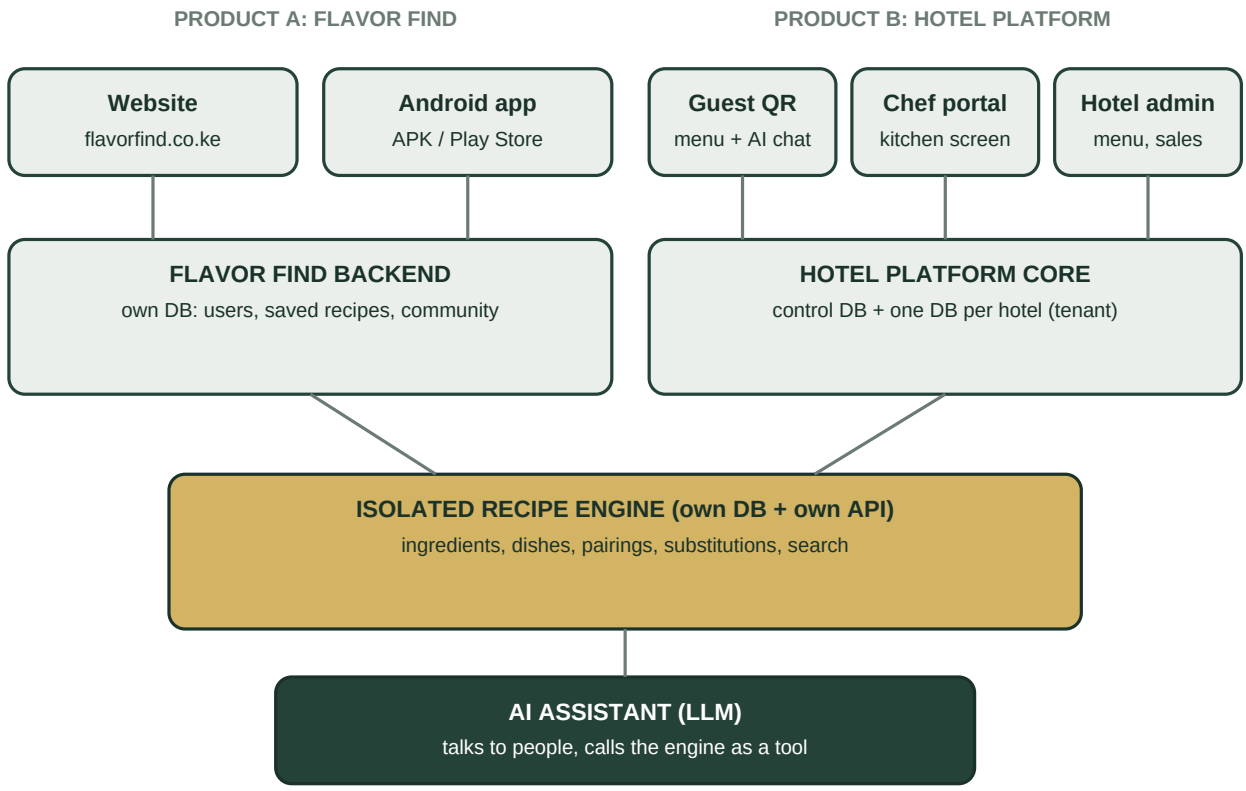
> **The one-sentence pitch:** Flavor Find is a food-intelligence engine for East Africa. It powers a consumer app that answers "what can I cook?" and a hotel platform that replaces paper menus with QR ordering and an AI waiter that actually understands the menu.

We are building **two products on one shared brain**:

- **Product A, Flavor Find (consumer):** website and Android app with its own backend and database. People enter ingredients or cravings and get exact, relevant recipes.
- **Product B, the Hotel Platform (business):** a multi-tenant system for hotels, restaurants, cafes and butcheries: QR menus, ingredient-based ordering, a chef portal, admin dashboards, payments and analytics. This is where most of the money is.
- **The Recipe Engine (shared, isolated):** its own database and API, consumed by both products and, later, sold to third parties.
- **The AI Assistant:** an LLM that talks to guests and users, but is only allowed to speak through the engine, so it stays accurate and safe.

Why this can work: the consumer app builds the data and the brand, the engine is the moat that is hard to copy, and the hotel platform turns all of that into recurring revenue.

2. System Architecture: Two Products, One Engine



Two separate systems that never share a database. They only meet at the engine's API.

Component	Own database?	What it stores	Who uses it
Recipe Engine	Yes (isolated)	Ingredients, dishes, pairings, substitutions, aliases, nutrition, cuisine tags	Both products, AI, future API customers
Flavor Find backend	Yes	User accounts, saved recipes, pantry lists, reviews, community submissions	Website and Android app
Hotel Platform core	Yes, plus one DB per hotel	Control DB: tenants, plans, billing, domains. Tenant DB: menu, orders, staff, sales, inventory	Hotels, chefs, waiters, guests
AI service	Small (logs, cache)	Conversation logs, prompts, usage and cost metering	Guests, consumers, chefs, owners

Design rules that keep this clean

- **The engine never knows about hotels or users.** It only answers food questions. Hotel-specific things (price, availability, custom dish names) live in the tenant DB and reference engine dish IDs.
- **Everything talks to the engine through one versioned API** with API keys, rate limits and usage metering. This also makes the engine sellable later.
- **The AI never touches any database directly.** It calls tools (search, pairings, menu, draft order) that enforce tenant permissions.
- **One codebase per product, many deployments.** Hotels get configuration and themes, not forks of the code.

3. The Recipe Engine (Shared and Isolated)

This is the core intellectual property. A normal recipe API does keyword matching. Ours should understand food.

Capability	What it means	Why it matters
Exact-match ranking	Typing "tomato" returns tomato-led dishes first, then dishes that contain tomato. Dishes are modelled with required and optional ingredients.	Fixes the main complaint with existing APIs
Aliases and languages	Sukuma wiki = kale = collard greens. Ndizi = banana. English, Swahili and Sheng names for the same ingredient.	Works for real Kenyan users and menus
Pairing graph	Ugali + sukuma + nyama choma. Chapati + beans. Mandazi + chai. Pilau + kachumbari. Drinks and sides per dish.	Powers upselling and the AI waiter
Substitutions	No tomato? Use tomato paste. No kale? Use spinach or cabbage.	Chefs and home cooks both need this
Dietary and allergen tags	Vegetarian, halal, gluten-free, nut-free, diabetic-friendly, fasting-friendly.	Safety, trust, wider market
Cost and portion awareness	Rough cost per serving in KES, portions for 1 to 200 people.	Budget cooking and catering
Nutrition estimates	Calories, protein and so on, with a clear confidence level.	Health features, premium tier

Capability	What it means	Why it matters
Region and cuisine tags	Coastal Swahili, Luo, Kikuyu, Luhya, Kamba, Kalenjin, Somali, Indian-Kenyan, Ethiopian and more.	A discovery and content engine

How matching works (simple version)

- Normalise the input (spelling, aliases, plurals, language).
- Find dishes where every required ingredient is covered, then dishes with partial coverage.
- Rank by coverage, then by popularity, region fit, dietary filters and cost.
- Return the dish plus what is missing, suggested substitutes and pairings.

Technology suggestion: PostgreSQL as the source of truth, with full-text and trigram search for fuzzy matching, and later vector search (pgvector) to let the AI match fuzzy cravings like "something light and spicy". Cache hot queries in Redis.

> **Engine as a product on its own:** once the data is strong, sell API access to supermarket apps, grocery delivery apps, nutrition and fitness apps, smart-kitchen brands and food bloggers. East African food data is rare, which makes it valuable.

4. Product A: Flavor Find (Consumer Website and Android App)

The consumer product is the shop window, the data collector and the brand builder. It also gives hotels a reason to trust us: "our engine already serves thousands of home cooks."

Feature	Description
Cook with what I have	Enter ingredients, get exact matches, near matches and what to buy to complete a dish.
Budget mode	"I have KES 300 for dinner." The engine suggests meals that fit.
Taste of 47 counties	A cultural library of Kenyan regional dishes with stories, a strong brand and content hook.
AI cooking buddy	Chat in English, Swahili or Sheng: "I want something quick with eggs and sukuma."
Meal plans and shopping lists	Weekly plans, a shopping list in KES, and share to WhatsApp.
Dietary profiles	Diabetic-friendly, vegetarian, allergy filters, family size.
Community recipes	Mamas, chefs and food creators submit recipes, verified before they enter the engine.
Diaspora mode	Cook Kenyan food abroad with ingredient substitutions available locally.
Offline saves	Saved recipes work with poor connectivity.

How Product A makes money

- **Flavor Find Plus** subscription (meal plans, nutrition, no ads).
- **Affiliate and delivery partnerships:** "add these ingredients to cart" with supermarkets and grocery delivery services.

- **Sponsored content:** brands such as flour, cooking oil and spice makers sponsoring recipes.
- **Lead generation for Product B:** restaurants discover us through the app.
- **Data and API:** the engine sold to third parties (see section 3).

Honest note: consumer apps in Kenya are hard to monetise directly. Treat Product A as the growth and data engine, not the main profit centre.

5. Product B: The Hotel Platform

This is a separate product with its own backend. Working name suggestion: **Flavor Find Dine** (or Flavor Find for Business). It is one big platform that can stamp out new hotels, each with their own backend, frontend, admin portal and chef portal.

5.1 The five portals

Portal	Users	Key functions
Super admin (us)	Our team	Create and suspend tenants, plans and billing, global menu library, support tools, usage and revenue dashboards, engine monitoring
Hotel admin	Owner, manager	Menu and prices, tables and QR codes, staff accounts, sales and analytics, branding, inventory, promotions, reports
Chef / kitchen	Chefs, cooks	Live order screen by table, status updates, prep summary, out-of-stock toggle, sound alerts, printer support
Waiter / floor	Waiters	Call-waiter alerts, table status, manual order entry, bill and payment status
Guest QR menu	Customers	No app needed. Browse, build a meal from ingredients, ask the AI, order, pay with M-Pesa, track status

5.2 The tenant factory (how one backend creates many)

The magic of this product is onboarding a new hotel in minutes, not weeks. The platform core runs a provisioning pipeline:

- Create the tenant record in the control database (name, plan, contacts).
- Create the hotel's database from a template and run migrations.
- Seed starter menu items from the engine's dish library.
- Create the subdomain (or attach a custom domain) and issue SSL.
- Deploy the hotel's branded frontend from a theme template (logo, colours, fonts).
- Create the admin and chef accounts and send login details.
- Generate printable QR codes for every table.
- Run a health check and switch the tenant on.

Because the frontend is template-driven, "a new hotel" is mostly configuration. Premium clients can get a custom design on top of the same core.

5.3 Database per hotel: the honest tradeoffs

You want every hotel to have its own database. That is a strong selling point (clean isolation, easy export, easy exit, comfort for large hotels), and it is achievable. Be aware of what it costs:

Approach	Pros	Cons
Database per hotel	Strongest isolation, per-hotel backup and restore, easy data export, premium selling point	Migrations must run across every database, more connections and cost, harder cross-hotel analytics
Shared DB with tenant_id	Cheapest, simplest, fast to build	Weaker isolation, a coding mistake can leak data, harder to guarantee per-hotel exports

Recommendation: build a tenant router from day one so both modes work. Use database-per-hotel as your default if you are confident, but automate it: a migration runner that updates all tenant databases, connection pooling (for example PgBouncer), and monitoring. Use a lighter shared setup for the cheapest plan if costs bite. Either way, keep a small analytics store where anonymised data from all hotels flows, so you can learn across the whole network.

5.4 Ordering experience

- Guest scans the table QR and the hotel-branded menu opens instantly.
- Guest either picks a dish or **builds one from ingredients** (chicken, rice, kachumbari...). The engine matches this to what the kitchen can cook.
- Pairing suggestions appear: drinks, sides, desserts. This is a real upsell engine.
- Order goes to the chef portal with table number and notes; the guest sees live status.
- Payment through M-Pesa STK push, card, or pay-at-table. Digital receipt included.
- Hotel owners see sales, best sellers, peak hours and wastage on their dashboard.

Add the FagiPay payment router here later if it is ready: it fits naturally as the payment layer for hotels that want to use their own paybill or till.

6. The AI Assistant

The AI is the feature that makes people say "wow", and it can reduce staff workload at the same time. The rule: **the LLM talks, the engine knows.** The LLM is never trusted to invent food facts. It asks the engine.

6.1 How it is wired

Step	What happens
1. Guest speaks	"I want something with chicken, not too spicy, and I am with a kid."
2. AI understands	The LLM extracts intent: chicken, mild, child-friendly, maybe budget.
3. AI calls tools	Tools exposed by the platform: search_by_ingredients, get_pairings, check_allergens, get_hotel_menu (this hotel only), draft_order.
4. Engine answers	The engine returns verified dishes and pairings. The hotel menu tool returns only what this hotel serves, with prices and availability.
5. AI replies	Friendly, short answer in the guest's language, with one-tap add-to-order.
6. Human confirms	The AI only drafts the order. The guest confirms and pays.

Isolation: the AI service has its own small database and holds no hotel data. Each call carries a tenant-scoped token, so the AI literally cannot read another hotel's menu.

6.2 What the AI can do, by user

User	AI features
Guests	Menu Q&A, craving-to-dish matching, allergy and diet filtering, portion and budget advice, Swahili/English/Sheng, voice, upsell suggestions, order drafting, tourist mode (translate dishes and explain what they are)
Chefs	Prep summaries ("12 portions of pilau needed in the next hour"), substitution suggestions when an item runs out, recipe standardisation
Hotel owners	Plain-language analytics ("why did sales drop on Tuesday?"), menu engineering (which dishes to promote, drop or reprice), auto-written dish descriptions, photo-to-menu digitisation (photograph the paper menu and import it)
Home cooks (Product A)	Cooking buddy, meal planning, budget mode, substitutions, step-by-step cooking help
Us (platform)	Support bot for onboarding hotels, data-cleaning assistant for new dishes

6.3 Guardrails (important)

- **Allergies are a safety issue.** The AI must never guess. Allergen answers come only from verified tags set by the hotel, with a standard disclaimer and a prompt to confirm with staff.
- **Prompt-injection protection:** guests must not be able to talk the AI into free food or changed prices. Prices and totals are always computed by the platform, never by the LLM.
- **Cost control:** cache common answers, use a smaller model for simple tasks, set per-tenant monthly limits, and meter usage so the AI add-on is profitable.
- **Fallbacks:** if the AI is down or slow, the normal menu always works.
- **Privacy:** comply with Kenya's Data Protection Act, 2019; minimise stored conversation data and be clear about retention.

7. Market, Relevance and How Big This Can Get

Why the timing is good, in plain terms:

- Mobile money is part of daily life in Kenya, so paying from a phone at the table is normal.
- Smartphones are widespread in cities, and QR codes became familiar after 2020.
- Restaurants are squeezed on cost and staffing, and anything that saves waiter time or increases average order value is easy to justify.
- Local-language, local-food technology is under-served. Global tools do not understand nyama choma, githeri or mukimo.
- KRA's eTIMS pushes businesses to digitise invoicing, a natural hook for a digital ordering system.

Please validate before you pitch investors: I have not quoted market statistics here because they must be sourced. Count venues from county business licence records, KNBS data, the Tourism Regulatory Authority hotel list, and Google Maps scrapes of restaurants in Nairobi, Mombasa, Kisumu, Nakuru and Eldoret.

7.1 Who to sell to (segments)

Segment	Why they buy	Priority
Mid-range restaurants and cafes (Nairobi first)	High table turnover, want upsell, chronic waiter shortages, smartphone-savvy customers	Start here

Segment	Why they buy	Priority
Nyama choma joints and butcheries	Ordering by weight, sides and drinks pairing, busy weekends, M-Pesa heavy	Start here
Mid-range hotels with restaurants	Need to modernise, multiple outlets, room service	Wave 2
Safari lodges and coastal resorts	Tourists need translation, dietary info, high spend per guest	Wave 2 (premium)
Fast food and food courts	Volume ordering, kiosk and QR, loyalty	Wave 2
University, corporate and hospital canteens	Prepaid wallets, meal plans, diet needs	Wave 3
Ghost and cloud kitchens	Many menus, delivery platforms, tight margins	Wave 3
Caterers and event planners	Quantity planning for 50 to 500 people	Wave 3
Franchises and chains (regional)	Multi-branch control, central menu, reports	Wave 4

7.2 How big can it get?

Three realistic ambitions, from smaller to bigger:

Level	Description
Local SaaS business	Several hundred venues in Kenya paying monthly. A solid, profitable company.
East African platform	Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Rwanda (and Ethiopia later) with local languages and payments. Thousands of venues plus transaction revenue.
Food-data and AI platform	The engine becomes the standard dataset and API for African food. Revenue from venues, API customers, supply-chain partnerships and ads.

Illustrative revenue model (assumptions, not forecasts): blended subscription KES 6,000 per venue per month, plus 1% on M-Pesa orders, with each venue processing KES 700,000 of orders per month through the platform.

Venues	Subscriptions / month	1% order fee / month	Total / month	Total / year
50	KES 300,000	KES 350,000	KES 650,000	KES 7.8 million
200	KES 1,200,000	KES 1,400,000	KES 2,600,000	KES 31.2 million
1,000	KES 6,000,000	KES 7,000,000	KES 13,000,000	KES 156 million

Remember: this is revenue, not profit. Subtract payment processing fees, hosting, AI costs, support and sales. The point is the shape: **transactions can rival subscriptions**, so getting orders and payments flowing through the platform matters as much as signing venues.

8. Pricing Strategy

You have two products, so you have two price lists. These are **starting hypotheses to test with your first 5 to 10 pilot venues**, not final numbers.

8.1 Product B: Hotel Platform

	Starter	Standard	Premium
Monthly (suggested)	KES 3,500	KES 7,500	KES 15,000+

	Starter	Standard	Premium
Setup fee (one-time)	KES 5,000 to 10,000	KES 15,000 to 25,000	KES 40,000+
QR menu and ordering	Yes	Yes	Yes
Chef portal	1 screen	Multiple screens	Multiple plus printers
Web address	Subdomain	Subdomain, own branding	Own domain, full white-label
M-Pesa payments	Add-on	Included	Included
Ingredient-based ordering and pairings	Basic	Full	Full
Analytics	Basic	Advanced	Advanced plus exports
Database	Shared or light	Own database	Dedicated database and backups
Inventory and loyalty	-	Add-on	Included
AI assistant	Add-on	Add-on	Included (fair-use limit)
Support	Email and chat	Priority chat	Phone, onboarding help

- **Order fee:** 0.5% to 1.5% on orders paid through the platform. Check that it covers payment provider charges.
- **AI add-on:** KES 2,500 to 5,000 per month with a usage allowance. Never price AI below its cost.
- **Custom website and domain:** one-time design fee plus yearly renewal.
- **Multi-branch:** a discount per extra branch to win chains.
- **Annual plans:** two months free to improve cash flow.
- **Free pilot:** 30 days free with setup done for them, to remove all risk.

8.2 Product A: Flavor Find (consumer)

Plan	Price	Includes
Free	KES 0	Search, basic recipes, limited AI chats, ads
Plus	About KES 199 to 299 per month	No ads, meal plans, nutrition, unlimited AI, offline recipes
Creator	Revenue share	Recipe creators earn from sponsored or premium recipes

8.3 The Engine API (later)

Tier	Price	Limits
Developer	Free	About 1,000 calls per month, attribution required
Growth	Monthly fee by volume	Higher limits, pairings and nutrition endpoints
Enterprise	Custom	SLA, dedicated capacity, custom data

Pricing principle: price on the value you create. If the platform raises a restaurant's average order by even 5 to 10% through pairings, the subscription pays for itself. Show hotels this maths in every sales conversation.

9. How to Market and Sell It

B2B SaaS for restaurants is sold by showing, not telling. The product demo happens on the customer's own table.

9.1 Phase by phase

Phase	Actions
Pilot (months 1 to 3)	Sign 3 to 5 friendly venues free. Set everything up personally. Sit in the restaurant, watch real orders, fix friction fast. Collect numbers: orders per table, average order value, waiter time saved.
Proof (months 3 to 6)	Turn pilot results into case studies and short videos. Build a "before and after" one-pager. Convert pilots to paying plans.
Local expansion	Founder-led sales in one dense area (for example, Nairobi's busy restaurant clusters). Visit venue after venue with a demo QR on a card. Add one or two commission-based sales agents.
Scale	Referral programme, partnerships, then other cities and countries.

9.2 Channels that fit Kenya

- **Walk-in demos:** a table-top QR card that lets the owner scan and try the menu in 60 seconds.
- **WhatsApp and Instagram/TikTok:** short food-and-tech videos, "watch an order travel from table to kitchen".
- **Food influencers and creators:** partner with Kenyan food creators for recipes in the consumer app, which also drives hotel awareness.
- **Industry associations and events:** hotelier and restaurant associations, food festivals, hospitality expos and trade fairs.
- **Suppliers and distributors:** flour, oil, beverage and meat suppliers visit restaurants daily. Make them referral partners with a commission.
- **Payment partners:** banks and mobile-money partners often co-market merchant solutions.
- **Referral rewards:** one free month for every venue a customer refers.
- **Sponsored dishes:** brands pay to be featured as recommended pairings, which funds growth.

Metrics to track from day one: venues live, orders per venue per week, average order value, percentage of orders paid via M-Pesa, monthly churn, AI usage and cost per venue, time to onboard a new hotel.

10. Wild Ideas for the Kenyan Market

A longer list so you can pick the ones that excite you. Not all should be built early.

Idea	What it is	Why it could work
WhatsApp ordering bot	Order and ask the AI over WhatsApp, no app or QR needed	WhatsApp is everywhere in Kenya

Idea	What it is	Why it could work
USSD ordering	Dial a code to see a hotel's daily menu on basic phones	Reaches feature-phone users
Supplier marketplace	Hotels buy ingredients from verified suppliers and mama mbogas through the platform	Opens a second, larger revenue stream: procurement commissions
Taste of 47 counties	Document one signature dish and story per county	Brand, press, tourism angle, data moat
Budget cooking	"What can I cook with KES 300?"	Highly relatable, shareable
Sheng and Swahili voice	Speak your order in local language	Huge differentiator, tourism and local appeal
Daily specials and surplus deals	Venues post end-of-day discounts to cut waste	Helps margins, drives traffic
Nyama choma by weight	Order by kilos with side pairings and live price	A uniquely Kenyan use case
Institutional canteens	Prepaid wallets for schools, universities, hospitals	Predictable, recurring volume
Health meal plans	Diabetic and hypertension-friendly Kenyan meals	Real need, premium subscription
eTIMS-ready receipts	Receipts compliant with KRA invoicing	Saves owners compliance headaches
Loyalty and tipping	M-Pesa points, tip the waiter or chef in-app	Staff retention, repeat visits
Event catering planner	Quantities and costs for 50 to 500 guests	Weddings, funerals, corporate events
Tourist mode	Dish explanations and translation in English, French, German, Chinese	Lodges and coast hotels love this
Chef community	Verified chefs publish recipes, get paid per view or sponsored dish	Content engine and supply of data
Engine API for others	Sell food intelligence to supermarkets, delivery and health apps	Platform revenue and defensibility

11. The Data Strategy (Your Hardest and Most Valuable Problem)

East African food is under-documented, so the data is both your biggest challenge and your biggest moat. Do not try to finish the database before launching.

- **Seed:** 300 core dishes that every Kenyan knows (ugali, sukuma wiki, githeri, pilau, chapati, nyama choma, mukimo, matoke, omena, mandazi, samaki, and so on). Enter them with required and optional ingredients, aliases and pairings by hand or with a small team.
- **Expand through hotels:** every onboarded hotel uploads its menu. The platform maps those dishes to the engine and grows the dataset for free.
- **Expand through community:** consumers and chefs submit dishes. New entries go through verification before reaching the engine.
- **Use AI to accelerate:** let an LLM draft ingredient lists and pairings, then have a human (a chef or food writer) verify. Never publish unverified AI output as truth.

- **Quality score per dish:** mark entries as seeded, community, chef-verified, so the engine can rank trusted data higher.
- **Own your data:** keep clear terms on who owns uploaded menus and community recipes.

12. Technology and Security Notes

Area	Suggestion
Backend	A mature framework you are productive in (Django, FastAPI, Laravel or Node). Choose for speed of delivery and a strong ecosystem.
Databases	PostgreSQL for the engine, Flavor Find and tenant databases, plus a small control DB for tenants. Redis for caching and queues.
Real-time	WebSockets (or server-sent events) for the kitchen screen.
Frontends	One template-driven web app (PWA) for guests and portals. Wrap it for the Android APK first, go native later if needed.
Hosting	Containers on a cloud provider with automated deployments and backups. Keep the engine in its own deployment so it scales separately.
Payments	M-Pesa Daraja (STK push) integration, with a payment layer that could later be swapped for your own payment router.
AI	A hosted LLM with function calling, a thin orchestration service, strict tool permissions, caching and per-tenant usage limits.
Security	Tenant-scoped tokens, role-based access, encrypted backups, audit logs, rate limiting, and a tested restore process.
Compliance	Kenya Data Protection Act, 2019 (register as required, privacy policy, consent), KRA eTIMS, and clear allergen disclaimers.

13. Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Deliverables
0. Foundations	Weeks 1 to 3	Final naming and branding, engine data model, seed 100 dishes, engine API v0 (ingredient search with exact matching)
1. Pilot MVP	Weeks 4 to 10	Hotel platform core with one tenant: QR menu, ordering, chef screen, admin basics. Pilot at 1 to 2 restaurants
2. Money and polish	Weeks 11 to 16	M-Pesa payments, analytics, tenant factory (automated onboarding), pairings, 300 dishes seeded
3. Consumer launch	Months 5 to 6	Flavor Find website, then Android app, AI cooking buddy, community submissions
4. AI waiter	Months 6 to 8	Guest AI assistant, chef and owner AI features, Swahili and Sheng
5. Growth	Months 8 to 12	Own-domain white-label, inventory, loyalty, WhatsApp ordering, supplier marketplace pilot
6. Platform	Year 2	Engine API for third parties, multi-branch chains, expand to Uganda, Tanzania, Rwanda

You do not need everything at once. The fastest path to learning is the pilot MVP in a real restaurant. Everything else is built on what that teaches you.

14. Risks and How to Handle Them

Risk	Mitigation
Scope is huge for a small team	Build the hotel platform first with a minimal engine. Ship the consumer app after the pilot. Cut features ruthlessly.
Data for East African dishes is thin	Hand-seed, expand via hotels and verified community, use AI drafts with human review.
Staff resist new systems	Make the chef screen extremely simple, train staff on site, keep a printed-menu fallback.
Weak internet in venues	Light pages, caching, local fallback for the kitchen screen, clear offline behaviour.
Allergy or AI mistakes	Verified allergen tags only, disclaimers, human confirmation, logged conversations.
Competition from QR menu tools	Win on ingredient-based ordering, pairings, Kenyan food depth, Swahili AI and M-Pesa-first design.
Costs of database-per-hotel and AI	Automate operations, price AI as an add-on, meter usage, offer a lighter plan.
Payment and regulatory complexity	Start with M-Pesa STK push, get advice on compliance, keep records for eTIMS and the Data Protection Act.

15. Decisions to Make Next

- **Names:** confirm "Flavor Find" for the consumer brand, and choose the hotel product name (for example, Flavor Find Dine).
- **Tenant model:** database-per-hotel for all plans, or only for Standard and above.
- **Pilot venues:** pick 2 to 3 places you can reach personally.
- **Data team:** who will verify dishes (a chef, a food writer, a nutrition student)?
- **Stack and hosting:** pick what you can ship fastest.
- **AI provider and budget:** decide the model, monthly cap and add-on pricing.
- **Funding path:** bootstrap from the pilot revenue, or raise once the pilot proves the numbers.

> **My honest view:** the winning combination is **Kenyan food depth + M-Pesa + an AI that speaks Swahili and Sheng + a one-click hotel onboarding factory**. Global QR menu tools cannot easily copy the first three, and the fourth lets you grow quickly once you have proof. Start narrow with the hotel platform pilot, protect the engine as a clean, isolated asset, and let the consumer app and AI grow from there.